Findings: experiments, confirmations and errors

Physicomimetics in BPP: what the conversion has found, kept up to date · 21 October 2026

A running record of what the conversion has found: the book's results we have reproduced, new results, errors and discrepancies in the book and in the other implementations, and our own mistakes, corrected. It is updated with every patch that finds something, and `FINDINGS.pdf` beside it is rebuilt each time. `BOOK.md` says what to build and `FIXES.md` what was fixed in the code; this file says what was learned.

How to read an entry. Each has an ID, the date, what was done, the numbers, where the evidence lives (a check script, a README or a probe), and a status: **Confirmed** (the book's claim, reproduced by our own measurement), **New** (a result the book does not have), **Book error** (the book disagrees with its own code, figures or arithmetic), **Book discrepancy** (the same, but small or an omission, not changing the conclusion), **Divergence** (NetLogo, the Android app and BPP differ), **Our error** (something we got wrong, and how it was found and corrected) or **Open** (measured but not yet settled).

Page numbers are PDF pages of `apbook1.pdf`; book page = PDF − 31.

1. The book's results, reproduced

F1. Appendix A: glibc `random()` is biased, and BPP uses it — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `checks/rng_appendix.lua`. BPP's `math.random` is glibc `rand()` = `random()`, in Lua 5.1 and 5.2 alike (William's BPP links 5.2, the cloud build 5.1). Run with Listing A.1's sampling (S extra calls per accepted point in the unit disk, 10^6 points, 36 bins, 99.9% cut χ^2 66.6), it fails at S = 25 (χ^2 321) and 27 (409), as the book shows (PDF 646–648); Lua 5.2 the same (321, 410); also S = 26 (223) and 3 (70). The multiply-with-carry generator now in `lib/rng.lua` passes at every S tried (χ^2 26–47).

F2. Ch. 2.1 spring1D, every result — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `checks/ch02.lua`, `ch02/README.md`. Momentum exactly 0; the separation oscillates symmetrically about D (27.000 to 73.000); period ×√10 at k = 1 (1.405 and 4.443); the centre of mass sits by the heavy mass at ratio 10; friction 0.001 drains the energy (2641 to 0.016) and the separation settles at D; changing D mid-run moves the energy to a new constant level (2641 to 998).

F3. Ch. 2.2 spring2D: angular momentum and the centrifugal stretch — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `checks/ch02.lua`. Angular momentum constant to 2×10^{-14}, linear momentum 10^{-12}; mean separation 77.8 > D = 50; the maximum exceeds 2D = 100 for every seed tried (111–118), with spring2D.nlogo's random start (F41).

F4. Ch. 2.3 solar_system, experiments a–e — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `checks/ch02.lua`. (a) A lighter sun gives a larger orbit, more so for AM 15 (87 to 133) than AM 10. (b) At Δt 0.1, AM 5 escapes (E from −121 to +111) and AM 0 is nonsense (E to 448,804). (c) At Δt 0.001, AM 5 orbits properly and AM 0 still shoots off left (x = −36,312). (d) Velocity caps fail: Vmax 9 drops the planet into the sun (|P| up to 891). (e) Force cap Fmax 1: bound, precessing rosettes (AM 4 precesses 112° per orbit); AM 0 swings through the sun, 0 to 15.6 away.

F5. Ch. 2.3e: the book's peak speeds are right — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `checks/ch02.lua`. The text's "5.6, 5, 4 and 9 (when AM is zero, one, four and nine)" (PDF 84–85) looked non-monotone, and `book/ch02.md` advised re-measuring. We get 5.50, 4.97, 4.00, 9.00. For AM 4 and 9 the start is the closest point, so the peak is the starting speed; AM 0 falls straight through the sun and AM 1 nearly does, so both peak near the centre.

F6. Ch. 11.3: the mean free path 0.651757, and 0.6079 with a buffer — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `ch11/README.md`, `checks/mfp_theory.lua`. The integral, computed to 60 digits, is 0.6517567914559… (Eq. 11.4 gives 0.651757); the 5% buffer gives 0.607939 (PDF 383: 0.6079). Listing 11.4 at 10^7 samples agrees within one standard error.

F7. Ch. 11.2: coverage converges to a seed-independent limit — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `HANDOFF.md` §6. As the book argues from ergodicity (PDF 380), long runs from different seeds reach the same deviation: at MFP 50 / 100 with one agent, 0.0158 / 0.0368 from both seeds to within 1%.

F8. Fig. 4.19: 100 agents cover more evenly than 1 at large mean free paths — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. At equal visits (5×10^7), MFP 30 / 50 give 0.0035 / 0.0158 with one agent and 0.00087 / 0.0035 with 100. Crowding adds turns, shortening the effective free path. Agents are near-independent only when they rarely meet.

F43. Ch. 13.2: the split-Newtonian point mass dithers across D — 2026-10-18, Confirmed (E2, PDF 447–449). `checks/ch13.lua`, `probes/settle_drones.lua`. The book says the sign flip at D lets a point mass dither across it with almost no net motion. The 2D particle replica of the drone law (G 1500, power 2.2, forceMax 1.5, D 50, friction 0.6, 40 particles) does exactly that: after 1,500 ticks the bonds are at 0.99 D but every particle still moves 0.55 units per tick. Flown by 50 drones the dither becomes real motion that never stops: 0.27 m/s (2D) and 0.47 m/s (3D) after 170 s, 190 and 324 AR-boundary crossings per drone per minute, and a suggested-position gap of 6 and 11 cm (3 seeds each). Lennard-Jones on the same drones settles in 20 s (2D) and at the last launch wave (3D).

F44. Ch. 13.5: AR damping η settles the Newtonian drones like LJ — 2026-10-18, Confirmed on drones (the book's Pioneers settle, PDF 454). `quadcopter/README.md` ("Ch. 13 on the drones"). With η (Eq. 13.9, power 1) and nothing else, the same 50 drones settle (scalar acceleration below 0.1 m/s² from then on; but see F52 for when the lattice is formed) 6 s after AP engages in 2D and 29 s in 3D, when the last launch wave joins (LJ: 20 s and 31–33 s); AR crossings fall to 0–1 per drone per minute, speed to 0.001–0.003 m/s, the gap to 0.03–0.09 mm, with no crashes (baseline 2 per 2D run). This answers `BOOK.md` §1 item 1's expectation: yes, η alone does it, because the law is then smooth through zero at D. The square and cube formations settle too: 6 s (2D square, LJ 23–25 s) and 27 s (cube, LJ 33 s), against 0.33 and 0.63 m/s of endless jitter without η; LJ's cube is the more regular (bond CV 0.007–0.03 against η's 0.07–0.09). The lattice η settles into is the subject of F45.

2. New results

F9. The mean free path in 3D: 0.7720 × the cube edge — 2026-10-17, New. `ch11/README.md`, `ch11/mfp_exact.py`, `checks/mfp_theory.lua`. For cubic cells with face neighbours, the mean distance from a robot uniform in a cube to entering the next is 0.771991712645..., or 0.713804 with the 5% buffer. An integer-relation search on the 60-digit integral finds $90\,f = 4 + 17\sqrt{2} - 6\sqrt{3} - 7\pi + 21\ln(1+\sqrt{2}) + 42\ln(2+\sqrt{3})$, agreeing to 50 digits (found by search, not proved). Listing 11.4 extended to 3D agrees within one standard error. In BPP's coverage box (edge 26⅔) that is a mean free path of 20.6, or 19.0 with the buffer, against 17⅓ in 2D.

F10. The 2D mean free path in one line — 2026-10-17, New. $12\,f = 2 + \sqrt{2} + 5\ln(1+\sqrt{2})$, equal to the book's Eq. 11.3–11.4.

F11. Uniform Coverage: deviation limits by agent count — 2026-10-17, New. At 5×10^7 visits (ticks × agents), mean of two seeds:

MFP	1 agent	10 agents	100 agents
1	0.0046	0.0036	0.0031
4	0.0028	0.0020	0.0024
10	0.0019	0.0023	0.0014
17	0.0021	0.0020	0.0014
30	0.0035	0.0036	0.00087
50	0.0158	0.0131	0.0035
100	0.0368	0.0347	—

MFP 30–100 have converged (seeds agree); MFP ≤ 17 are still falling as 1/√visits and are upper bounds. At equal visits one agent covers as evenly as ten, so what agents buy is time (F8 is the exception, when they crowd).

F12. The book's integrator: energy swings but does not drift — 2026-10-17, New. `checks/ch02.lua`, `checks/monitors.lua`. Semi-implicit Euler keeps energy bounded, with a swing inside each cycle of about $\Delta t\cdot\omega$: 0.45% for spring1D at Δt 0.001, 16% at the closest approach of the AM 15 orbit at Δt 0.1, 8% for AM 5 passing 1.6 from the sun at Δt 0.001. The drift between the start and end of a run is 10^{-4} or less for the springs and 0.2% for the

coarsest orbit. The energy error is first order in Δt (10.2× smaller for 10× smaller Δt). "Constant energy" in the book means no drift.

F13. Ch. 3's obstacle field, measured from the figures — 2026-10-17, New. `lib/world.lua` (`World.CH03_DISCS`). Both panels of Fig. 3.25 give the same 12 disc centres within a pixel, shifted as a group (F40). Scale 2.11 px per patch at 300 dpi from the discs (20 across), confirmed by the formation's 63.3 px node spacing (D = 30). In the model's world (701 × 401, goal at (−175.25, 0); F40) the field's centre is at (−8, −11); the closest gap is 5.2 patches ("narrowly spaced"). Fig. 3.26 is a different field (F37).

F42. spring3D stays in one plane — 2026-10-18, New. `ch02/Spring3D.lua`: from random 3D starts, L keeps its direction to 2×10^{-12} degrees.

F45. η shrinks the lattice when the range reaches second neighbours — 2026-10-18, New. `checks/ch13.lua`, `quadcopter/README.md`. In 2D at the default range 1.5 D, η settles the drones at 0.83 D (power 1) and 0.805 D (power 2.2) instead of D, on all 3 seeds; the particle replica gives 0.82–0.85 and 0.79–0.81, so this is the law, not the drones. η damps the nearest neighbours' repulsion near D far more than the attraction of the second neighbours, which come inside the range (at √3 a) once the lattice spacing a falls below 0.866 D. Balancing the two in an infinite triangular lattice gives a / D = (1 + c) / (1 + √3 c), with c = 3^((1 − P) / (2 p_η)) for law power P: 0.800 (p_η = 1) and 0.762 (p_η = 2.2); a finite swarm's edge, with fewer second neighbours, sits a little wider, as measured. Keeping the second neighbours out restores the spacing: range 1.25 D gives 0.986 D on the drones (1.001 D as particles), with the best lattice of any run (Delaunay CV 0.069 against LJ's 0.092 and the baseline's 0.11). The 3D triangle's default range is already 1.25 D, and it settles at 1.01 D.

F46. The stop rule needs η — 2026-10-18, New. With the sign flip, the summed force is almost never small: a stop threshold of 0.01 or 0.03 (AP units; in 2D the force just either side of D is ±0.27 per neighbour) held 0.04–0.3% of drone-ticks in 2D and none in 3D, and the swarms jittered on as before. With η it holds every drone once settled (residual speed 10^{-4} m/s in 2D, 10^{-9} m/s in 3D), with the same settling time and lattice as η alone, so it does not freeze the swarm before it has formed.

F47. η softens the lattice: smooth flight, but it gives under load — 2026-10-18, New. With η (power 1) the force's slope at D is F(D)/D: 0.0055 per AP unit in 2D and 0.0085 in 3D, against LJ's $c\cdot p/D^2 = 0.024$, so the lattice is a quarter to a third as stiff (the plain law has no slope at D, only a step). Under the same load η therefore needs about four times LJ's strain. Crossing the default obstacle field after the moving goal (640 s, 2 seeds), η's drones fly smoothly (acceleration below 0.1 m/s² throughout, mean speed 0.10 m/s against the jittering baseline's 0.20 / 0.40 m/s), lose none, and travel slightly farther than the baseline but less far than LJ (swarm centre at 632 s: −46 m against −43 and −50 in 2D; −47 against −41 and −51 in 3D). Under the goal's constant pull their bonds shrink to 0.85–0.92 D in 2D and 0.94–0.95 D in 3D, where LJ's stay at 0.97–1.0. η at the law's own power (2.2 in 2D) settles no better than power 1 and leaves the lattice smaller (0.87 D at range 1.25, still creeping outward after 170 s), so power 1 is the better default.

F49. η has two resting states: switched on after forming, the lattice stays at D — 2026-10-18, New; found by William in the GUI. With η on from the launch, the 2D swarm settles at 0.83 D (F45). Switched on once the plain law has spread the swarm (60 s after AP engages, 3 seeds), the same drones settle within about 2 s at 0.96–0.97 D in 2D, and at 1.00–1.01 D in 3D with bond CV 0.035–0.055, the most regular Newtonian lattice measured (η from the start 0.063, LJ 0.044, plain law 0.083). The particle replica does the same (0.988 D; `checks/ch13.lua`). Both states are equilibria: from a compact cluster the expansion passes through spacings below 0.866 D, where second neighbours are in range and η's balance stalls it; a lattice already near D has them out of range, and η only removes the dither. William's reading: it is annealing, with η as the cooling — the plain law's dither (Ch. 13's "jumpiness", PDF 449) is the heat that lets the lattice reach D, η from the start is a quench into the compressed state. Next: a cooling schedule (ramp `etaPower` 0 → 1) and the fastest cooling that still reaches D.

F50. η in a band tied to D: no trap, a stiffer lattice, and a stiffness limit set by the drones — 2026-10-18, New; William's idea. Damping only within $|D - r| < w\cdot D$ (`etaWidth`; w = 1 is Eq. 13.9) leaves the far forces alone, so from the launch the 2D swarm no longer stalls: bonds 0.83 D (w 1), 0.85 (0.5), 0.98 (0.25), 0.999 (0.15) on 50 drones, 3 seeds each; the particle replica reaches D for w ≤ 0.2, as the F45 balance predicts (no trap for w below about 0.26).

w 0.15 gives the best 2D lattice measured (Delaunay CV 0.064; LJ 0.092). Too narrow brings the jitter back: 2D at w 0.1 crashed 4 drones, and 3D at w 0.15 kept jittering in 2 of 3 runs, at 0.1 fully (0.32 m/s). The edge falls at the same slope of the damped force at D, F(D)/(w·D), in both dimensions: 0.034–0.037 per AP unit settles, 0.055–0.057 does not (LJ's slope is 0.024). So the band can be set from the law and the separation, w ≈ F(D)/(0.04 D): 0.14 in 2D, 0.21 in 3D. One w = 0.2 works in both: 2D settles (by the acceleration test; formed at 76–96 s, F52) at 0.994 D (Delaunay CV 0.077), 3D at the last launch wave at 1.01 D (bond CV 0.054), no crashes. Crossing the obstacle field after the goal (2 seeds), w 0.2 holds its bonds at 0.93–0.94 D (2D) and 1.00 D (3D), where w 1 gave 0.85–0.86 and 0.94–0.95 and LJ 0.97 and 0.99, but it is slower: swarm centre at 632 s −43 m in 2D and 3D (w 1: −46, −47; plain law −43, −41; LJ −50, −51). The stiffer lattice threads the columns no faster than the jittering one; LJ is both stiff and fluid.

F51. Ch. 13.4.1.1: adaptive friction damps the dither but cannot stop it, and alone it freezes the swarm — 2026-10-18, Confirmed in part (PDF 463–465), New in part. `quadcopter/README.md`. Eq. 13.23 per axis on the drones' AP velocity (`muMore`, `muLess`), plain Newtonian law, from the launch, 3 seeds. The book's ratio condition holds: at kMore/kLess 2.5 and 10 (kLess 0.02) the swarm keeps moving (2D 0.12 and 0.04 m/s, 3D 0.22 and 0.08 m/s); at 25 it falls below 0.1 m/s² in 6 s (2D) and 30–32 s (3D). But the drones still cross D 104 (2D) and 220 (3D) times per drone per minute, at 0.014 and 0.023 m/s: the small-amplitude oscillation that the book says remains after adaptive friction and that its static friction removes (§13.4.1.4, PDF 465). Our acceleration test alone calls these runs settled; the crossing count shows they are not. The cost is mobility: that residual dither keeps flipping the commands' signs, so mu stays at 0.8–0.9 and damps the goal's pull too. Crossing the obstacle field (2 seeds) the swarm's centre reaches only +4.5 m (2D) and +8.3 m (3D) in 632 s, against −43 and −41 m for the plain law: the book's "too much damping impairs reactivity" (PDF 463). With η in its 0.2 D band (F50) the dither is gone, so mu decays (0.08–0.11 settled, 0.12–0.26 while following the goal): by the acceleration test settling looked a little faster (5 s 2D, 29–30 s 3D), but the lattice forms later in 2D (91–117 s against 76–96 s, F52), the lattice the same (0.993 D, Delaunay CV 0.082; 3D 1.01 D, bond CV 0.054), and the crossing slightly slower (−40, −38 m against −43, −43 m). In 2D alone it compresses the lattice (0.92–0.94 D); in 3D at ratio 10 it gave the most regular lattice measured (bond CV 0.023) while still moving at 0.08 m/s.

F52. Settling times corrected: when is the lattice formed? — 2026-10-18, Our error, corrected (FIXES 41; found by William in the GUI). The settling times in F44, F50 and F51 came from the acceleration test, which a slow outward creep passes: with η in its 0.2 D band the 2D bonds were still growing from 0.89 to 0.99 D over ~165 s while it said 5–10 s. Timed instead as *formed* (bonds ≥ 0.97 of the spacing and mean speed < 0.01 m/s from then to the end; 285 s runs, 3 seeds, seconds after AP engages):

	2D formed	2D bond CV	3D formed	3D bond CV
η (book band) from the launch	never (0.83 D)	—	42–57	0.063
η, band 0.2 D, from the launch	76–96	0.066	66–154	0.053
η 0.2 D + adaptive friction	91–117	0.066	76–85	0.053
η (book) switched on at 60 s	never (0.96 D)	—	68	0.044
η (book) switched on at 150 s	157	0.046	158	0.020
η 0.2 D switched on at 60 s	88–106	0.063	72–79	0.047
Lennard-Jones	30–35	0.023	51–64	0.015

William's way — the plain law first, η once the swarm has spread to D (F49) — gives the most regular Newtonian lattices, formed about 7 s after the switch; but the plain law needs ~150 s of jitter to reach D in 2D (switched at 60 s, η freezes it at 0.96 D), while in 3D it is there by 60 s. The narrow band is the fastest from the launch in 2D but slower than the book's band in 3D; adaptive friction slows 2D and speeds only the narrow band in 3D. LJ forms fastest in both.

F53. Switching η on per drone by a local rule does not work — 2026-10-18, New (negative). To automate F49, each drone turned η on, and kept it on, by a local test of its own neighbours (one checkbox, no new number). Two tests, 285 s, 3 seeds, 2D and 3D, book band and 0.2 D band: *every neighbour within range at least 0.97 D* never forms a lattice in either dimension (a few drones never pass, keep jittering at 0.06–0.14 m/s and shake the rest; in 2D the

early ones freeze patches at 0.93 D); *the mean distance to the neighbours within range at least 0.97 D* passes at once in the launch cluster (neighbours out to 1.5 D average near D), so it is η from the launch again (2D 0.83 D with the book band; 0.2 D band formed at 100–106 s, no better than without the switch). Anything between the two is a new number to tune, so the switch was taken out (HANDOFF §2, simplicity). The local rule that works is η in a band of 0.2 D from the launch (F50, F52); switching η on later is a choice made by hand.

F54. Ch. 13.4.1.4: static friction does not settle the drones — 2026-10-18, New. Eq. 13.25 with the corrected condition $\mu \cdot m \cdot g < |F|$, per axis on the adaptive μ, the plain law without η (the book's whole Pioneer recipe). g is set by the book's own scale, not tuned: g = 9.81 against forces of ~100 at D (Fig. 13.3), so g′ = 0.098 F(D). At muMore 0.2 and 0.5 (muLess 0.02), 3 seeds, no run forms: the drones keep crossing D 123–343 times per drone per minute, as with adaptive friction alone (F51), and in the obstacle-field crossing the swarm is as frozen (centre +3 to +8 m in 632 s). At 10× the book's g′ it is no better (128–367 crossings): blocking an axis zeroes its command, μ decays, and the drone moves again. The book's reasons for it — a minimum wheel speed and poor position estimates (PDF 465) — are absent on these drones (no minimum speed, perfect sensing); it belongs with the ground robots of M2 and with sensor noise (G7). With LJ, F(D) ≈ 0, so it would do nothing.

F55. Ch. 13.4.1.3: the adaptive speed cap is not needed on the drones — 2026-10-18, New. Eq. 13.24 with one reading per tick (the nearest column surface or drone, so no beam count) and the Pioneer's values scaled to the quadcopter (1.5 / 0.3 m/s, 1.5 m, k_less/k_more 12.5). Crossing a field twice as dense (61–65 columns) after a goal twice as fast (0.4 m/s), 2 seeds, LJ and Newtonian with η: no drone hit a column with or without the cap, and progress was the same within noise (e.g. Newtonian 3D centre at 374 s −12.8 / −14.4 m without, −13.9 / −14.5 m with). The cap never binds: AP's commands stay at 0.1–0.2 m/s, because the obstacle repulsion was already made gentle for these airframes (FIXES 17–23). The only losses are drone–drone collisions in the 2D LJ launch, before the cap could matter. It belongs with faster swarms and with ground robots whose ranging sees obstacles late.

F56. Defaults that work out of the box: η on, band 0.2 D in 2D and 0.5 D in 3D — 2026-10-18, New. William's decision: the drones keep only `etaPower` and `etaWidth`, on by default in the Newtonian scene. Measured with no settings changed (285 s, 3 seeds; launch only, no field): with 0.2 in every mode, the 2D triangle forms at 76–96 s (0.993–0.998 D), the 2D square at 53–170 s (0.97–0.98 D), the 3D triangle at 66–154 s, but the 3D cube keeps jittering in 2 of 3 runs (53 crossings per drone per minute): the 3D law's F(D) is 0.42, so the slope at D, F(D)/(w D), is 0.042, at the edge found in F50. A 0.5 band forms the cube at 80–128 s (0.99 D) and the 3D triangle at 45–50 s (1.008 D, faster than LJ's 51–64 s). So the band follows from the two limits — slope at D below about 0.035 per AP unit (w ≥ 0.16 in 2D, ≥ 0.24 in 3D) and, in 2D at range 1.5 D, w < 0.26 against the second-neighbour trap — and is set per mode: 0.2 in 2D, 0.5 in 3D. The default scene (field, moving goal) loses no drones: swarm centre at 630 s −42 / −44 m in 2D and −45 / −46 m in 3D (plain law −43 and −41, LJ −50 and −51), bonds 0.93–0.98 D under the goal's pull.

F57. Three truly 3D models: a flipping tetrahedron, stable planets, a ringing lattice — 2026-10-18, New. `ch02/README.md`, `checks/ch02.lua`. Two bodies always move in one plane (F42); these need three or more. (a) **Tetrahedron**, masses 1–4 on six springs: an asymmetric top (moments 4390 / 5840 / 7270). Spun 2° off the smallest or largest axis it stays within 3–4° of L for 48 turns; off the middle axis it flips end for end 7 times in 48 turns (5–10 for tilts 0.5–5°, spin 0.3–0.5, k 10–40): the tennis-racket (Dzhanibekov) effect from springs alone, with |L| fixed to 10^{-14} and E to 6×10^{-5}. (b) **Planets**, solar_system's law and units without caps, 4 planets at $15 \times 1.8^{i-1}$ tilted up to 10°: at 1/1000 and 3/1000 of the sun each, all radii stay within 1–3% for 150 outer orbits (3 seeds); at 1/100 one seed of three breaks up by 150 orbits; at 3/100, 1/10, or spaced 1.3× apart, a planet is thrown out. The orbits' tilts drift by degrees as the planets tug on each other. Stability needs light, widely spaced planets, a time step of a few hundred per inner orbit, momentum balanced at the start and circular speeds — and no caps. (c) **Spring lattice**, 3 × 3 × 3 masses with springs on edges and face diagonals (126; edges alone shear flat): it rings without end with P = 0 and L fixed, and with friction settles into the perfect cube (strain 6% to 10^{-8}).

F58. Elliptical orbits: two rules keep several planets stable — 2026-10-18, New (William's question: circles worked, ellipses did not). `ch02/Planets.lua`, `checks/ch02.lua`. Measured with the book's integrator (3 planets, 6 seeds, 20 outer orbits unless stated): (a) **Spacing.** An ellipse swings between a(1 − e) and a(1 + e), so the spacing that works for circles lets elliptical orbits approach or cross. Keeping the *gap* — the outer orbit's nearest point over the inner

orbit's farthest point — at the circles' 1.8 (ratio of semi-major axes 1.8 (1 + e)/(1 − e)) holds them: at e 0.3 and 0.5 every orbit stays within 1–6% of its shape for light planets (1/1000 of the sun) and within 16% for heavy ones (1/100), 12 of 12 runs; e 0.7 also holds. At gap 1 (orbits touching) light planets are scrambled (up to 42% past their farthest point) and heavy ones break up in 11 of 12 runs; at circular spacing with e 0.3–0.5, 4 of 12 light runs broke. (b) **Time step.** The nearest-point pass lasts about √(rp³/GM), rp = a(1 − e), much shorter than the orbit. With about 50 steps across it (Δt = √(rp³/GM)/50) one planet keeps its energy within 1% (e 0.5) to 7% (e 0.9) and its orbit does not turn; with 4 steps (e 0.9 at Δt 0.01) the energy swings 88% at each pass and the orbit turns about 1° per orbit; with 1 step, 640% and 157° — and with neighbours, the system breaks. The book's integrator keeps a lone orbit's size even then (it is symplectic), so the damage shows in the energy and the turning, not the size. *Our error, corrected:* the first measure of "broke" used each planet's osculating semi-major axis about the sun, which heavy planets distort by moving the sun; it called stable heavy systems broken. Farthest and nearest distances against the orbit's own a(1 ± e) are the right test.

F59. A pile from a truck: η from the launch is still the best way — 2026-10-19, New (William: in wartime the drones are dropped as a pile, not placed). The default launch is that pile: drones 1 m apart on the ground, so in 2D, where all fly at one altitude, neighbours start ~0.86 D apart (D = 3 m) and the swarm must expand; in 3D the thirds climb to their own levels already ~D apart. Without η the plain law's jitter needs ~150 s to shake out the 2D pile's defects (the 10th percentile of each drone's mean first-shell distance stays ≤ 0.90 D for over 100 s). From the pile, 2D, 280 s, 3 seeds (formed, s / bond CV / drones lost): η from the launch (default) 76, 87, 96 / 0.066 / 0; take-off in thirds, η on 106, 171, 138 / 0.057 / 0; one drone at a time, η on 185, 167, 148 / 0.066 / 0; a per-drone switch latched on once its own first shell (within 1.25 D) averages 0.97 D: 123, 172, 275 / 0.061 / 2 every run; the same switch two-way (η on only while the shell is at D) never forms (bonds 0.95–0.98 D, CV 0.13) / 2 every run, and with the take-off in thirds never (CV 0.13). The two-way switch was meant as local annealing, but drones near the threshold keep turning η off, and each time they jitter again: the heat never falls. Later waves must push into a lattice already damped. In 3D the latched switch formed at 42–53 s (CV 0.060) and the two-way one at 63–277 s, no gain over the defaults. With the drones placed 1.8 m apart (neighbours ~0.96 D), η from the launch forms at 27–33 s, but that is not a pile. So nothing was added (HANDOFF §2): the defaults already get a good lattice from the pile, about 1.5 min in 2D and under 1 min in 3D, and the switch code was removed. LJ forms from the same pile in 30–35 s (CV 0.023): the faster way is in the force law's shape, not in a switch.

F60. The world generator's terrain and water: meanders, the slope rule, and two mistakes of ours — 2026-10-20, New and Our error, corrected. `lib/terrain.lua`, `checks/terrain.lua`. (a) **Meanders.** A river drawn as a sine-generated curve (heading 1.1 sin φ to the valley; Langbein and Leopold 1966) has sinuosity 1/J0(1.1) = 1.390: a 41.7 km test river measures 1.391 and a meander wavelength of 10.9 widths (Leopold and Wolman: 10–14; ours 11). Varying each bend's length by ±30%, so meanders are not all alike, keeps the sinuosity, because a bend's sinuosity does not depend on its length. The presets' rivers measure 1.39–1.40, the city's (only 2.5 meanders long) 1.43. (b) **The slope rule** (no dry slope steeper than 15% along the grid, by lowering only) also makes the river valleys' walls, the ponds' banks and the dry part of dredged cuts, so none needs its own setting. Across a triangle it allows up to √2 × 15% = 21.2%, and four of the five presets reach that on valley walls; that is what "drivable" means here. (c) *Our errors, corrected:* dredging with 1:3 sides after the slope rule left 33% dry banks where a channel ran up into land; sloped cuts now come before the rule and only vertical quay walls after it. Hills drawn as noise of either sign dug an inland hollow 15 m below sea level behind the harbour town (245 nodes); hills now stand on the plain (0 to their height). And a Lua trap worth knowing: `f(t, g(), fn)` passes only g's first result when g returns several (Lua cuts a call's results to one unless it is the last argument). (d) Each preset builds in 0.1–0.4 s in Lua 5.1, and a seed gives identical terrain on Lua 5.1–5.4.

F61. Zones and streets: the published LCZ fractions, and a connected network from one rule — 2026-10-20, Our error, corrected, and New. `lib/town.lua`, `checks/town.lua`. (a) *Our error:* `BOOK.md` §6 gave the open low-rise zone 15–25% built and the sparsely built 5–15%. Stewart and Oke's table (2012, Table 3) gives 20–40% and 10–20% (compact high-rise 40–60% and > 25 m, as we had). `Town.LCZ` now holds the published ranges for all ten built zones, and the buildings (next patch) will be calibrated to them. (b) **One rule makes the network whole:** keep only the streets connected to an arterial. Without it, grid streets cut off by the city's river, stubs at the edges of zones and the port's grids (which stopped 24 m short of their arterial) were left as islands: 15 pieces in the city, 11 in the harbour

town, 14 in the port, 1 in the suburb. With it every street is reached from an arterial, which `checks/town.lua` confirms independently by flooding a 4 m raster of the streets (39,441 sample points, all reached). The port's districts were then laid to meet their arterial, so it drops none. (c) **Woods' share** has to be calibrated on the land it applies to: a noise cut taken over the whole area gave woods on 25% and 40% of the open land when 30% was asked; taken over the open land alone it gives 30.0%. (d) A BPP trap: a Lua local named `Terrain` (our terrain module) hides BPP's global `Terrain` mesh class in that file, and the viewer showed nothing; the module is now `Land` there. Zones and streets build in 0.02–0.3 s and a seed gives identical streets on Lua 5.1–5.4.

F62. Buildings calibrated to the published LCZ ranges, and what it took — 2026-10-20, New and Our error, corrected. `lib/buildings.lua`, `checks/buildings.lua`. (a) **Result.** Every built zone covering ≥ 3% of a preset now falls inside Stewart and Oke's ranges, on seeds 1–3 (building fraction / mean height): city compact high-rise 41–45% / 56–64 m (40–60%, > 25 m); compact mid-rise 40–46% / 18–19 m (40–70%, 10–25 m); open mid-rise 23% / 18 m (20–40%, 10–25 m); harbour-town compact low-rise 45–48% / 7 m (40–70%, 3–10 m); open low-rise 22–24% / 5 m in the suburb and the harbour town (20–40%, 3–10 m); sparsely built 12.5–13% / 5 m (10–20%); port large low-rise 33–35% / 8 m (30–50%, 3–10 m); heavy industry 22–23% / 11–12 m (20–30%, 5–15 m). The city's skyline has a heavy tail (median 17.5 m, 99th percentile 80.5 m, tallest 171.5 m, 49 floors), and its mean height falls from 65 m within 150 m of the centre to 31 m and then levels at 18 m, as Schläpfer et al. (2015) describe (heights fall near the centre, then settle). (b) **The suburb's streets were too sparse.** Cul-de-sacs hung off collectors 400 m apart left block interiors empty: open low-rise 10.6% and sparsely built 5.3% built, a third of the published range. Measuring where the land went (28% street, 47% lots, 25% neither) pointed at the network, not the houses. Local streets 80 m apart between the collectors, half of them cut midway into cul-de-sacs, now carry the lots (55 km of street in the suburb, about 2,300 houses). Cutting needed care: a piece was first assumed to meet a collector at its uncut end, but an end at a zone's edge meets nothing, and those pieces were reversed, trimmed and dropped; locals are now split where they actually cross the collectors. (c) **The gap rule and the setbacks interact.** Back-to-back compact buildings with 1–2 m rear setbacks stood 2–4 m apart, inside the forbidden 0–3 m, so the rule narrowed them and left gaps along the streets; compact zones now have a rear setback of half the minimum gap (1.5 m), and a building breaking the rule gives up depth before width. (d) *Our error, corrected:* lots were first tested against the streets at 3 × 3 points, and on 110–150 m industrial lots whole 20 m streets passed between the points: lots straddled streets and the port's heavy industry read 21.5% built where the honest figure was 18%. The test is now exact (distance from each street segment and turning circle to the lot's rectangle), with water sampled every half cell. (e) The city's centre first sat on its river, which took a quarter of the high-rise zone's land and held it at 36–39% built; it now lies 150 m north. (f) A Lua trap: `goto` does not exist in Lua 5.1 (BPP's cloud build). Lots and buildings take 0.8–3.4 s per preset in Lua 5.1 and are identical on 5.1–5.4.

F63. Mission features and trees: what measuring them corrected — 2026-10-20, New and Our error, corrected. `lib/features.lua`, `lib/vegetation.lua`, `checks/features.lua`. (a) **The storm drain must flood at its outfall.** With the culvert's roof kept under 1 m of cover, a 2 m culvert needs 3 m of ground over its floor; the bay's head is a low shore (~1 m), so the drain leaves the land below sea level: its last 35 m of 458 lie under water, a tide-locked outfall, which real low shores have too. It is recorded (`flooded`) rather than hidden, and matters to the capstone: robots in the drain cannot leave by the sea end. (b) *Our errors, corrected:* the port's ship first sat 2 m off a quay wall that the terrain mesh draws as a slope one 8 m cell wide, and its corner read as aground (−7 m clearance); ships now stand off by a cell and 1 m of fenders (under-keel clearance 3–6 m). A warehouse on a slope had doors 5 m over its lowest ground, which left the uphill door less than 2 m high; doors are now 5 m over the ground at each door. (c) **The gap rule is about obstacles, not pairs.** Container stacks two rows apart are 2.44 m apart, under the 3 m rule, but the row between them closes the gap; the check now merges touching buildings into one obstacle before applying the rule (what the Android app's rule means: gaps between obstacles fit an agent or are closed). (d) **Counts** (seed 1): street trees 7,900 in the suburb, 4,300 in the city, 5,200 in the harbour town; the rural preset has 1,640 lengths of hedgerow and woods as a canopy over 25% of its open land; the harbour town's yard holds 130 stacks in 3 blocks with 6 pockets, the port's 345. (e) **Traps** (open ground no street reaches, 2 m raster): 0.54% of the harbour town's old town and 0.04% of the city core; few, because U-shaped courts open to the rear and back-to-back lots leave 3 m passages. A whole preset builds in 0.4–3.5 s in Lua 5.1, identically on 5.1–5.4.

F64. Rivers: the sine-generated curve was far too periodic — 2026-10-20, Our error, corrected (found by William). `lib/terrain.lua`, `checks/terrain.lua`. F60's rivers followed Langbein and Leopold's sine-generated curve, the *most probable* meander shape, with each bend's length varied by ±30%. Every bend still had the same amplitude and shape, and the rivers read as a pattern: the direction's autocorrelation between points three meanders apart was 0.98. Natural meanders are irregular; Ferguson (1975) found their direction autocorrelograms are *damped* oscillations, and modelled the channel's direction as a damped oscillator kicked by random disturbances (the disturbed periodic model, Ferguson 1976; an AR(2) process with one step a channel width, as fitted to rivers worldwide by Limaye et al. 2021, who note disturbances σ ≥ 0.3 a width are rare). Ours: period 11 × 1.4 widths along the channel, memory falling to 1/e over one meander, the direction smoothed over ~2 widths (no bend tighter than about two widths, Leopold and Wolman), and neck cutoffs where the channel meets itself. Over three 30 km rivers: sinuosity 1.39, wavelength 11.0 widths, autocorrelation three meanders apart 0.02, σ 0.21 a width, no channel touching itself. Steering toward the river's end, the cutoffs and the rounding each take some sinuosity away (1.36 → 1.30), so the disturbances' variance carries a measured gain of 1.5 that restores the mean to 1.4. Downstream every layer moved with the rivers and was measured again: every built zone stays inside its LCZ ranges on seeds 1–3. *Two of our checks were too tight for the new layouts:* F62's heavy-tail test (99th percentile ≥ 4 × the median) rests on a few dozen towers and varies 3.4–4.8 × across seeds; it is now skewness > 3 (measured 4.1–5.7) and tallest ≥ 5 × the median (6.6–10 ×). And the harbour town's quay now holds two large lots, so the yard takes one and one warehouse is made, as many as there are sheds.

F66. Ground robots freeze in the minimum-speed gap, as the book predicts; Ch. 13's frictions do not get the split law to D — 2026-10-21, Confirmed (book's prediction, PDF 452–453) and New (the numbers). Milestone M2, `ground/README.md`. 50 Pioneer 3-AT robots (book: r_diff 0.3 m, wheels 0 or 0.1–0.5 m/s, u_max 0.5 m/s, Ω_max 0.4 rad/s) under the quadcopter scenes' laws and settings, 2D triangle, compact launch, 180 s, seeds 1–3. A robot moves only while the force on it exceeds friction × 0.1 m/s / (metersPerUnit × apHz) = 0.2 AP units; below that every wheel is in the gap and it stands exactly still (10^{-6} m/s), the book's "agents get stuck in low-energy formations because the forces are too small to move them" (Fig. 13.7). Lennard-Jones, stiff at D, freezes within 1–2% of D: formed at 31.7 s, bond 0.98–0.99 D, bond CV 0.068–0.074 (drones 0.022–0.034). The split Newtonian law has only 0.28 at D, and η (band 0.2 D) damps it under 0.2 out to ~0.14 D from D: frozen at 0.89 D, CV 0.19–0.21, never formed. Without η the robots dither across D at the minimum speed (141–151 crossings per robot per minute), the oscillation the book says the Pioneers had before static friction (E11d). Adaptive friction 0.5/0.02 (Eq. 13.23) cuts that to 44–47; static friction (Eq. 13.25) at the book's scale (g′ = 0.098 F(D)) leaves 38–56 and at g′ = F(D) 75–85: the book's threshold is ~10% of the force at D, and this dither is driven by the full step at D, so static friction cannot stop it. η in a band of 0.05 D freezes at 0.93 D; η at range 1.25 D at 0.94 D with CV 0.12–0.14, the best Newtonian lattice on robots (range 1.25 was the best on drones too, F45). None forms, so none is kept (HANDOFF §2). *The guidance found two rules in its own check* (`checks/vehicle_physics.lua`): without a turn-rate limit of |u_d| / r_diff a robot asked to creep spun on the spot at 0.4 rad/s, and a pivot on a wheel stopped in the gap reached 0.56 rad/s until the other wheel was held to 2 r_diff Ω_max.

3. Errors and discrepancies in the book

F14. Listing 11.4's printed result — 2026-10-17, Book discrepancy. `ch11/listing_11_4.lua`, `ch11/README.md`. The listing's entry is at $x_2 = 1.001$ (exact mean 0.652501); the text prints 0.6517. With the book's generator (glibc, srandom(1), Lua 5.1) the listing gives 0.652454, 9 standard errors away, but 0.651711 = "0.6517" at $x_2 = 1$, so the text's run most likely used $x_2 = 1$ (inferred).

F15. Ch. 2.3d: the velocity cap's effect on the orbit's shape — 2026-10-17, Book discrepancy. `checks/ch02.lua`. At Vmax 12 the book says the orbit "runs well, with a slight linear-momentum change". It is slight (|P| ≤ 3.0), but the orbit shrinks unmentioned from 15–87 to 15–18: the cap cuts the start speed 15 to 12. solar_system.nlogo caps as we do (scaling the speed, keeping the direction); clipping each component gives 14.9–18.4.

The chapter notes list further suspected errors in the listings (Ch. 3, 6, 7, 9, 13, 18; `BOOK.md` §1 item 11). They are not yet re-checked by measurement and will be entered here as each chapter is ported.

4. Differences between implementations

F16. Uniform Coverage: the wall rule decides the large-MFP results — 2026-10-17, Divergence (kept by decision). `FIXES.md` 36. NetLogo turns when the patch 1 ahead or either patch 2 away at ±45° is wall; the Android app, and BPP from it, turns only on touching the boundary. With NetLogo's rule swapped into BPP (one agent, 10^7 ticks), MFP 30 / 50 / 100 give 0.0074 / 0.0227 / 0.0271, reproducing NetLogo's own 0.0072 / 0.023 / 0.026. The Android rule gives 0.0035 / 0.0158 / 0.0368: better at every useful MFP, worse only at 100. NetLogo is not maintained; the Android/BPP rule stays.

F17. Uniform Coverage: the two known Android bugs barely matter — 2026-10-17, Divergence. `FIXES.md` 4–5. The one-sided neighbour cone (0–30° for ±15°) and the dropped ninth move were real, but move the deviation about 3%, so BPP and Android agree (MFP 30, 100 agents: 0.00087 against 0.00085).

F18. Earlier NetLogo and Android numbers at small MFP came from longer runs — 2026-10-17, Open. William's old values at MFP ≤ 17 (0.00027–0.0016) sit below our 5×10^7-visit upper bounds, so those runs were longer. Their lengths were not recorded.

F19. Zarzhitsky's map format, kept by the Android port — 2026-10-17, Confirmed. `lib/world.lua` (`writeCPT`). A text file of nx lines of ny characters, `' '` open, `'b'` blocked. His PlumeGen, rebuilt from source, loads a map written by our generator and reports the same coverage (3.6%). Its reader as shipped wants a square of at most 1024; ours writes any size.

F48. `formation_newton.nlogo`, the book and the BPP port use different defaults — 2026-10-18, Divergence. The law is the same in all three (`netlogo/README.md`). The model's sliders are G 310, power 2, Force_Maximum 1, Desired_Separation 30, Friction 0.15, Time_Step 1, 50 particles; the book's text gives G 400 for the same model (`book/ch03.md`); both are above the clustering threshold G_t = 259.8, so the model clusters by design. The BPP ports take their 2D defaults from the Android app's `MyPanel.java`: G 1500, power 2.2, forceMax 1.5, D 50, friction 0.6, which is below its G_t (2368). Ch. 13's damping is in none of them.

5. Our own errors, corrected

F20. "NetLogo's MFP 30 and 50 values come from short runs" — 2026-10-17, Our error. With NetLogo's wall rule BPP reproduces NetLogo's values (F16), so they had converged; a short run can only raise the deviation.

F21. The seed slider would not move — 2026-10-17, Our error. `FIXES.md` 34. Found by William. BPP stores slider ranges as floats and turns them into an integer slider; a maximum of $2^{31} - 1$ overflowed it. Now 0–1000; larger seeds go through `SEED`.

F22. R in Uniform Coverage reset the seed — 2026-10-17, Our error. `FIXES.md` 34. R was BPP's own reload, which resets every slider to its default, so a chosen seed never applied. Uniform Coverage now binds R to a new scatter, and a seed change restarts the scene in every demo.

F23. The world viewer was mirrored top to bottom — 2026-10-17, Our error. Found by comparing with Fig. 3.25. Book y now maps to BPP −z, so a camera looking down −z sees the book's orientation.

F24. Energy "flat" tested as no swing — 2026-10-17, Our error. The first Ch. 2 checks failed seven times on the integrator's normal within-cycle swing (F12); they now test drift and report the swing separately.

F25. The repository ignored `lib/` — 2026-10-17, Our error. The root `.gitignore` rule `lib` (for build output) silently left the new folder out of the first commit; an exception was added.

F26. A test hook replaced the scene's own — 2026-10-17, Our error. BPP keeps one `postSim` callback, so a probe that set its own stopped the simulation. Probes now use `preDraw` and `preStop` (`lib/batch.lua`).

F27. The 3D mean free path estimate — 2026-10-17, refined: an earlier ≈ 0.7717 (4 M samples) is within error of the exact 0.771992 (F9).

F33. The checks assumed `lua5.1` was installed — 2026-10-17, Our error. Found by William (Lua 5.3 only): every check failed for want of the interpreter, and three used `math.atan2`, gone in 5.3. `checks/run_all.sh` now runs them inside BPP, else any Lua; all code runs on 5.1–5.4.

F37. Fig. 3.26 drawn as Fig. 3.25's discs enlarged — Our error, found by William. Obstacles are placed by mouse clicks, so Fig. 3.26 has its own field: six discs fitted to its outline (preset `ch03-wall`); drawn over the figure, they trace it.

F38. Fig. 3.26's discs measure radius 45, the text says 50 — Book discrepancy (small). Radius 95 px at the scale confirmed by the lattice (F13); the field covers 24.8% of the panel, ours 24.6%.

F39. Code against William's instruction went out in a commit of ours — Our error. Another session's `cpt-textron` preset reached master because I staged the folder unread. Removed; diffs are now read first.

F40. Both figures' obstacles shift between panels: cropping — 2026-10-18, Our error (small), settled by the `.nlogo` and Fig. 3.23: each panel crops ~305 patches of a 701 × 401 world, which we took for the world. Pushing moves a heavy (10^5) obstacle ≤ 0.01 patch/tick. Presets use the model's frame.

F41. Ch. 2's starts guessed, then checked against the .nlogo — 2026-10-18, Our error (small). spring2D now starts at random headings and spring1D's light mass on the right, as the models; F3 barely moves.

6. How BPP behaves (worth knowing for every port)

F28. Headless results depend on `delayMs` (FIXES 1): its throttle uses wall-clock time; `lib/batch.py` sets it to 0.

F29. R reloads the script and resets every slider unless a scene binds R itself; the toolbar restart restores the sliders after reloading (F22).

F30. One callback of each kind: `v:postSim`, `v:preDraw`, `v:preStop`, `v:onParamChanged`; setting another replaces it (F26).

F31. Slider ranges are floats turned into integers (value / step): keep them well inside $\pm 2^{31}$ steps; values above 2^{24} are not exact (F21).

F32. Scripts run in their own folder in the GUI; scripts in subfolders add `../?.lua` to reach `lib/`.

F34. BPP's Lua depends on the build: 5.1 or 5.2 (`bpp.pro`), not the standalone `lua`: William's is 5.2, the cloud build 5.1 (`bpp -l 'print(_VERSION)' -n 1`). The checks and the generator's stream agree on 5.1–5.4.

F35. BPP runs a scene as soon as it loads; S stops and restarts it. GUI tests that "pressed S to start" were stopping runs (our error).

F36. Huge "off" values make unusable sliders (Force_Maximum 0.1–10^6 could not be set to 1; found by William). Caps now get a tick box and a slider over the useful range. Same root as F31.

F65. A saved Lua path wins over the script's own folder (found by William, 2026-10-20): BPP uses `lua/path` from its settings (`~/.config/bullet-physics-playground.github.io/bpp.conf`, `[lua] path=`) whenever every folder in it exists, and falls back to the default path (the script's folder and its parents, then `demo/`) only when one is missing (`src/viewer.cpp`, `src/prefs.cpp`). Pressing OK in Preferences saves the path shown, which is computed from where BPP was started. With two checkouts, a path saved in one is used by the other, so `require "common"` failed for `batch_repeat` there. Clear the line (or the field in Preferences) to get the default path back.

7. Open questions

- F18: the limits at MFP ≤ 17, which need about 10^9 visits to resolve.
- The 3D threshold G_t for the cube formation (`BOOK.md` §1 item 9), to measure with a G sweep.
- How to keep η's spacing at D in 2D at range 1.5 D (F45): a shorter range works, as do switching η on after the lattice forms (F49) and a narrow band tied to D (F50). Whether the slope limit (~0.04–0.05 per AP unit) follows from the drones' lag and AP rate, and holds for other apHz. Static friction and the adaptive speed cap on ground robots with a minimum speed and real ranging (M2), and with sensor noise (G7); on the drones they are not needed (F54, F55). And whether the next Ch. 13 mechanisms (adaptive and static friction) settle the drones without η's loss of stiffness (F47).
- Getting a 2D lattice from a pile faster than η's ~1.5 min (F59): LJ does it in 30–35 s, so the lead is the shape of the force law near D.
- Ground robots with a minimum speed (F66): how to make the small moves that finish a lattice and escape a stall behind a column. The threshold is friction × v_min / (metersPerUnit × apHz) in AP force units, so the law's stiffness near D, apHz and friction all move it.